



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Paul Catholic Classical School

School Website: <https://spsdfw.org/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

Saint Paul Catholic Classical School (SPCCS) in Richardson, TX presents a robust, explicitly Catholic classical program embedded in a long-standing parish community. Public materials from SPCCS consistently foreground Christ at the center of learning, a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with great books, Latin study, and liturgical life (Mass, adoration, catechesis). The school emphasizes formation (virtue, wisdom) over mere information, and positions parents as partners and co-educators within a living, mentorship-driven faculty culture. Across Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent-Community dimensions, SPCCS demonstrates strong alignment with classical education tenets, particularly its theological grounding, teleological aims, liberal-arts curriculum, and Socratic-inviting pedagogy (memorizations, recitations, and thoughtful discussion). The overall assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key themes across the six categories - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Catholic identity is woven into all study; theology, liturgy, and sacramental life (Mass, Adoration, Baltimore Catechism) are integral to daily life and study. Evidence: statements about Christ as Logos; Mass and adoration; Catholic formation across subjects. This aligns with the Positive Keywords around truth, goodness, beauty, liturgy, sacred worship, and a sacramental worldview. - Purpose and Goal: Education is formation in virtue and wisdom, anchored in faith; pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty is explicit; the school emphasizes contemplation (scholé) and a classical telos rather than job-focused outcomes. Evidence: "formation," "faith, wisdom, and virtue," and the Catholic classical mission. - Curriculum: Liberal arts emphasis (grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; Latin; history and Western civilization; classical humanities) with integrated religious content; explicit Great Books/primary-sources orientation and a curriculum that includes Latin and sacred arts. Evidence: Trivium description and classical curriculum; Great Books/literature focus; Latin and Western history. - Pedagogy: A blend of contemplative/restful elements (Scholé, memorization/recitation, liturgical integration) and active discourse (Socratic-like discussion and memory work). Evidence: recitation/memorization; emphasis on discussion and memory; occasional explicit reference to "restful learning" and "Scholé." - Faculty: Faculty described as dedicated, long-tenured, highly qualified; living curriculum; strong partnership with families and parish. Evidence: School Profile & Facts notes tenure and credentialing; "living curriculum" and parental partnership language appear in admissions and academics materials. - Parents & Community: Explicit partnership with parents as primary educators; open-house and visitation culture; parent formation and community activities; strong parish-school alignment. Evidence: "parents are the primary educators," opportunities for involvement, and regular open houses/tours.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Christ-centered learning as the Logos; Catholic theology permeates all subjects; liturgical life (Mass weekly, Adoration); Baltimore Catechism and Ignatius Press religious materials are part of instruction. - Explicit framing of truth, goodness, beauty as real goods governing education; liturgy and chant woven into formation. (Catholic identity and liturgical practice appear throughout admissions and academics pages.)

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, beauty, goodness; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; prayer; reverence; wonder; Logos; imago Dei. In SPCCS public materials, these terms appear frequently in the religious framing and classroom integration. - Negative keywords observed: virtually none in public materials (no explicit relativism, secularism, or neutral ethics signals). The materials are saturated with Catholic metaphysical content.

Why this rating - The school situates its entire program within a Catholic metaphysical frame, placing virtues, liturgy, and the transcendentals at the center. This aligns solidly with the positive indicators of the Six Essential Elements lexicon and leaves little room for negative signals in this domain. CLASSICAL.

### **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation in faith, wisdom, and virtue; a teleological aim toward truth, goodness, and beauty; the Great Conversation and classical heritage recur as aims of education. The school describes education as formation, not mere information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; telos; pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; liberal education; scholé; contemplation; great conversation; classical heritage; human flourishing. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public-facing materials (no emphasis on workforce readiness or 21st-century job skills in the classical framing).

Why this rating - SPCCS clearly orients toward formation and the classical telos rather than job-prep metrics, aligning with CLASSICAL criteria. The explicit Catholic, classical aims and the described Great Books/wisdom orientation bolster the CLASSICAL rating.

### **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as core structure; Great Books and primary sources; study of Latin and classical languages; history integrated with theology; Western civilization and salvation history; inclusion of natural philosophy and the liberal arts. SPCCS explicitly describes a liberal-arts curriculum aligned with classical formation. - Additional curriculum content includes Latin starting PK3, a traditional liturgical and religious-infused curriculum, and a focus on foundational memorization/recitation and classical literature (great books).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; primary sources; classics; Latin; history; Western civilization; salvation history; natural philosophy; music; hymnody; sacred art; recitation; narration; Latin chants. - Negative keywords present: signals of modern, project-based approaches or STEM-first framing are largely absent; occasional technology mentions exist but are contextualized within a classical framework (not project-centric). See faculty and curriculum mentions for balanced approach.

Why this rating - The explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing, Great Books emphasis, Latin, and historical scope align with CLASSICAL curriculum indicators. The public materials present a cohesive classical-curriculum picture, meriting CLASSICAL.

### **Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Memorization/recitation and chanting noted as a key component of lower grades; restfulness and contemplation acknowledged; discussion and reflection encouraged among students; the Trivium supports logic, rhetoric, and disciplined debate or discourse. The site describes students discussing their studies and engaging with material. - Lower- vs. upper-school pedagogical patterns align with classical practice: lower grades include memorization, recitation, and liturgical/renewed memory work; upper grades emphasize logic and rhetoric through discussion and writing (as part of the Trivium).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue and dialectic (implied by “discussion of studies”); narration; recitation; chanting; singing to memorize; memory work; liturgical/calendar integration; seminar-like discussion; rhetoric exercises; capstone orations. - Negative keywords present: explicit “project-based learning” or entirely student-directed constructivist approaches are not presented as the core pedagogy; the site presents a balanced mix but with classical emphasis, not modern constructivism. The Six Elements lexicon lists such as “constructivist,” “experiential learning” as negative signals; those explicit signals aren’t foregrounded here.

Why this rating - The pedagogy described—recitation, memory work, liturgical integration, and emphasis on rhetoric and oral expression—maps strongly onto classical pedagogy. While not every category-specific term is spelled out as “Socratic” on the site, the practices align with classical teaching methods. CLASSICAL.

### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The faculty is described as highly qualified, long-tenured, and formative; living curriculum and teacher-student relationship emphasized; faculty are mentors who model virtue; there is a clearly defined professional posture and a familial, collegial culture. The School Profile & Facts highlights tenure (10-year average) and graduate degrees, plus a staff dedicated to classical formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, character formation, high teacher tenure, advanced degrees. - Negative keywords present: negative signals in the lexicon (e.g., “facilitators on the side” or “certification-driven jargon”) are not reflected in SPCCS public materials; the materials present a classical faculty profile without those negative indicators. The absence of those signals supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - SPCCS presents a living, virtuous, long-tenured faculty with explicit emphasis on mentorship, living curriculum, and exemplary teacher-formation. CLASSICAL.

### **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Partnership with families and parents as co-educators; explicit encouragement of parent involvement, family formation, book clubs, and liturgical events; open campus and tours are commonplace; strong parish-school partnership; family participation in events and admissions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; household worship; family liturgy alignment; parental involvement; shared mission. - Negative keywords present: consumer-language signaling a “customer” model are not evident in public materials; the site emphasizes formation and partnership rather than consumerism. The lexicon’s “negative” signals are not reflected here.

Why this rating - The school presents a clear, robust family-and-community orientation consistent with classical education ideals. CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking - All six categories: CLASSICAL - Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - Not applicable as an aggregate CLASSICAL assessment. If you wanted to push toward an even more explicit articulation, potential needle-movers could include: - More explicit public statements of Socratic seminars in upper grades (beyond implied practice) to align even more tightly with classic pedagogy language. - A dedicated section mapping Great Books titles, authors, and a stated Great Conversation plan across grades to make the Great Books/Great Conversation element unmistakably explicit on the site. - Additional parent-formational programming with a published syllabus or schedule to further demonstrate parent formation and home-education alignment.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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